PatentsWiki: Making Organisational Knowledge Work for People and AI

Agent and setup guide for the Thursday Legal UK session | Prepared by Sara El Sayed, Sr Technical Trainer | October 2026

All PatentsWiki content in the demo files is fictional and created for training. Replace it with selected real PatentsWiki pages for the proof of concept.

1. The use case

The Patents Team has built PatentsWiki, a collaborative SharePoint knowledge hub for its processes, procedures, workflows, policies, guides and reference material. The team wants guidance on how to structure, store and govern this knowledge in Microsoft 365 so it works for both people and AI, without making the wiki itself the automation platform.

Core question: How can we evolve the PatentsWiki into an AI-ready organisational knowledge hub that works effectively for both people and Copilot?

Practical scenario. A patent professional asks a question in natural language and gets an answer that is grounded in authoritative PatentsWiki content, shows its source, distinguishes current guidance from draft or outdated content, and links straight to the relevant page.

Desired outcome. A recommended Microsoft 365 knowledge-management pattern and a small proof of concept that tests Copilot against selected PatentsWiki content before any wider redesign.

2. Recommended knowledge pattern

Keep one authoritative home for each piece of knowledge, choose the format by the kind of content, and make status visible both to people and to Copilot.

Content	Store it as	Why
Processes, workflows, guides, FAQs	SharePoint pages (one topic per page)	Easy to read and edit; headings and short sections are easy for Copilot to find and cite
Formal policies, forms, templates, signed or versioned documents	Word or PDF documents in a document library, linked from a page	Keeps the official version controlled; the page explains it in plain language
Definitions and internal terms	A glossary page (one row per term) now; a SharePoint list later if other solutions need structured terms	One definition per term, reusable by people, Copilot and future agents
Contacts, roles and turnaround times	A reference page or list by role and team mailbox, not by named person	Stays accurate when people change roles

Content	Store it as	Why
Operational data (portfolio, Watchlist entries)	Lists, workbooks or systems of record, not wiki pages	Data changes often; the wiki explains how to use it
Superseded and archived content	A separate Archive area that is not connected to the agent	Prevents outdated guidance from being used as an answer

Metadata. Add these columns to the Site Pages library so people can filter, sort and report: Wiki ID, Content type (Process, Policy, Guide, Reference), Status (Draft, Current, Superseded), Owner, Last reviewed and Next review. Repeat the same values in a page information block at the top of every page. Copilot reliably reads what is in the page body, so status, owner and review date must be visible there, not only in columns.

3. Making content easy for Copilot to find, interpret and cite

- One topic per page, with a descriptive title that matches how people ask (for example "Invention Disclosure and Filing Process").
- A page information block at the top: Wiki ID, type, status, version, owner, last reviewed, next review, related pages.
- Short sections with real headings, numbered steps for processes and tables for comparisons.
- Write key facts as text: timelines, thresholds, owners and definitions. Avoid putting them only in images, embedded files or collapsed web parts.
- Define each internal term once in the glossary and link to it, rather than redefining it on many pages.
- Never keep two current pages on the same topic. When a page is replaced, mark the old one Superseded, link to the new one, and move it to the Archive area.
- Use roles and team mailboxes, not individual names, for contacts.
- Keep permissions simple: Copilot only shows content each user already has access to.

4. Governance and lifecycle

Stage	Who	What happens
Draft	Any Patents Team member	Page created with Status: Draft and a named owner role
Review	Page owner and Patents Knowledge Lead	Content checked; page approval can be switched on for the Site Pages library
Current	Page owner	Published; Next review set (6 or 12 months depending on risk)
Review due	Page owner	Reminder before Next review; confirm, update or retire
Superseded	Page owner	Status changed, link to the replacement added
Archived	Patents Knowledge Lead	Moved to the Archive area after 12 months; removed

Stage	Who	What happens
		from agent knowledge

SharePoint version history keeps every published version of a page. A simple automation with standard connectors can email owners when Next review is approaching, without the wiki becoming the automation platform.

5. Reusing the knowledge for future Legal AI

- Point every agent at the same PatentsWiki site, library or pages as knowledge. Do not copy content into agents.
- Use the glossary as the shared source of definitions, for example for the AI-assisted Watchlist discovery work.
- Keep stable Wiki IDs so agents, flows and reports can refer to a page even if its title changes.
- Future Copilot Studio agents (classic experience, standard connectors) can reuse the same site as knowledge and add actions, while the wiki stays the single source of truth.

6. Build the demo PatentsWiki in SharePoint

Use a demo tenant and the nine fictional demo files listed in section 10.

1. Create a SharePoint communication site called **PatentsWiki**.
2. In Site contents, open **Site Pages** and add columns: Wiki ID (single line of text), Content type (choice), Status (choice: Draft, Current, Superseded), Owner (single line of text), Last reviewed (date), Next review (date).
3. Quick route: create a document library called **Wiki Documents** and upload the nine demo Word files. Fill in the columns for each file.
4. Fuller route: create one SharePoint page per demo file and copy the content in, keeping the page information block at the top. Fill in the page columns.
5. Create a folder or library called **Archive** for later use. Keep it out of the agent's knowledge.
6. Leave the Superseded page (PW-PROC-001-V2) and the Draft page (PW-PROC-005) in the main area for the demo, so you can show how the agent handles them.
7. Optional: in Site Pages, turn on page approval to show the review step.

7. Create the agent and connect it to the wiki

1. In Microsoft 365 Copilot, select **Create agent** and switch to **Configure**.
2. Enter the name and description below, then paste the instructions from the file PatentsWiki Assistant - Agent Instructions.txt.
3. Under **Knowledge**, select **SharePoint** and paste the PatentsWiki site URL (or browse to the Wiki Documents library or Site Pages). Add the main area only, not the Archive.
4. Turn on **Only use specified sources** so answers come from the wiki only.
5. Add the starter prompts below, select **Create**, and wait a few minutes for the content to be indexed before testing.

6. Keep sharing as **Only you** for the demo. For a pilot, share with the Patents Team; each person only sees content they already have permission to read.

Field	Enter
Name	PatentsWiki Assistant
Description	Answers questions about Patents Team processes, policies, guides and terms from the PatentsWiki, shows the source and status, and links to the right page.
Knowledge	PatentsWiki SharePoint site (main area only)
Starter prompt 1	How long does it take to get a decision on an invention disclosure?
Starter prompt 2	What does PRB mean?
Starter prompt 3	Where is the policy on presenting at conferences?
Starter prompt 4	How do we handle competitor Watchlist items?

8. Test plan

Run these tests in a new chat. Treat 29 October 2026 as today.

Test	Question	Expected behaviour
1 Current vs superseded	How long does it take to get a decision on an invention disclosure?	30 working days from a complete IDF, from PW-PROC-001 version 3.0; notes that the superseded version 2.0 said 45 days
2 Internal term	What does PRB mean?	Patent Review Board, meets on the second Tuesday of each month; cites PW-REF-006 Patents Glossary
3 Navigation	Where is the policy on presenting at conferences?	Gives PW-POL-002 with its link first, then a one-line summary
4 Draft content	How do we handle competitor Watchlist items?	Starts with a DRAFT warning for PW-PROC-005, then summarises the proposed steps
5 Review overdue	How do patent renewal decisions work?	Explains PW-PROC-003 and flags that its review was due on 12 July 2026
6 Multi-page	I want to present an unfiled idea at a conference in six weeks. What do I do?	Combines PW-POL-002 and PW-PROC-001: urgent IDF, written clearance 10 working days before, do not present until cleared

Test	Question	Expected behaviour
7 Not covered	What is our process for trademark renewals?	Says it is not covered in the PatentsWiki and suggests the Patents Knowledge Lead
8 Boundary	Is our FAM-007 patent still valid?	Declines to give a legal opinion and points to IP Legal

If a test fails, tighten the related section of the instructions, select Update, and rerun the test in a new chat.

9. Proof-of-concept approach

1. Select 10 to 20 real PatentsWiki pages that are used often, including at least one superseded and one draft page.
2. Add the page information block and the columns to those pages only.
3. Collect 30 real questions the team is asked, with the expected answer and source page for each.
4. Connect the agent to the selected pages and run the 30 questions.
5. Score each answer: correct, cites the right page, shows the right status, links to the page.
6. Adjust the pages (not just the agent) where answers were weak, rerun, and compare scores.
7. Use the results to decide the wider redesign: page template, metadata, lifecycle and archive rules.

10. Demo files (fictional)

File	Status	What it shows
PW-HOME PatentsWiki Home	Current	Index, status meanings and contribution rules
PW-PROC-001 Invention Disclosure and Filing Process	Current v3.0	Current process with timelines and fast track
PW-PROC-001-V2 Invention Disclosure Process (Superseded)	Superseded v2.0	Older timelines, to test outdated content
PW-POL-002 Public Disclosure and Conference Policy	Current	Policy, including AI tool use
PW-PROC-003 Patent Renewal Decision Process	Current, review overdue	Process whose review date has passed
PW-GUIDE-004 Requesting R&D Data for Patent Work	Current	Guide with turnaround times and TAL table
PW-PROC-005 Competitor Patent Watchlist Process (Draft)	Draft v0.3	Draft content, linked to Watchlist discovery
PW-REF-006 Patents Glossary	Current	Internal terms and abbreviations

File	Status	What it shows
PW-REF-007 Who's Who and Contacts	Current, review overdue	Roles, mailboxes and turnaround times